

DARREN "COUNT VOLPO" HORDERN

IN SHORT: You're an entitled white dude who just wants to be appreciated. Also, you're a were-wolf, sorta.

THE WORST THING THAT EVER HAPPENED TO YOU:

It's hard to point to one thing, but a steady downward slide started when you graduated in 2003. You couldn't find a job that used your finance degree, so you wound up working at a diner and... how? You did everything right. How'd you end up the night manager of Pancake Town?

You looked for answers online and boy howdy did you find them.

WHERE YOU ARE NOW: You're a **Sleeper**, but also sort of a sleeper **Sleeper**, if that's not too clever. Baldly, you're a double agent for the Orthodox Order of Saint-Germain (or OOSG), embedded in with a bunch of soft, regretful headcases who can pervert reality. You've been told to watch and wait and make friends, which is sometimes a pain because you're a tough, resolute headcase who can pervert reality.

YOUR INTRODUCTION TO THE OCCULT:

You made some online friends and in '04 went to your first Resolution Rite in the wilds of Montana, partaking in your ancient ancestral rituals to bring up the animal soul and return your spirit to a true perception of nature. It was pretty great, but you kept going in for harder and more authentic initiations until you wound up with some dudes who were re-creating the Úlfhéðnar traditions of pre-Christian Germany. You have actually turned into a no-shit wolf, in every sense that matters.

The great thing about being a modern *ulfserk* is, when you've purged yourself of all the civilized brainwashing and expectations, you can then put on society like a coat, consciously and selectively. You appreciate wine and classical music now, your manners are exquisite (in human form), and you have become the *regional* manager for Pancake Town.

You're also a footsoldier for the Orthodox Order of Saint-Germain, a secret society devoted to wresting the world free from the shackles of its hidden masters and returning it to the rightful dominion of the Comte de Saint-Germain.

WHY ARE YOU WILLING TO DRIVE TO CANADA AND INTERFERE WITH A BURGLARY?:

The Orthodox Order of Saint-Germain said to do it, and they're your family now. The Sleeper cell in New Mexico, where you're from, also said to do it, and they're your second-rate family now. You're actually planning to steal the sacred head from some chumps after they do the hard work of getting it out of the museum.

YOUR CABAL

- **Mansteel:** An all-right guy, if perhaps over-compensating for something. Maybe a little hard on Chirp. Not one of the Sleepers, but he's pretending for now.
- **Chirp:** Mansteel's hot little wife, or girlfriend, you don't know. A real doll, if you like your women waiflike and frail and uncertain. As it happens, you do. Also, she's your OOSG superior, so everything from the central leadership flows through her.
- **Guadalupe:** She's from a very different tradition, a Mexican tradition, which is fine. Really. It's fine. Less fine is the squishy compassionate humanism. When you're within the civilized context that's great, hundred percent. But occult stuff is in the margins and sometimes you just gotta throat somebody out, wolf-style. You don't think Guadalupe's got that in her.
- **The Darkness:** OK, we get it, you're an androgynous emo flutist, your gender identity is "spooky," sheesh. Though, shit, if you're going to commit to a bit, having your first name legally changed to "The" and your last name to "Darkness" is at least as cool as it is stupid.
- **Harper Grilsh:** Harper's OK as a person, but there's something extremely scary that's... in orbit around Grilsh. Like, anyone who really bugs Harper winds up shot to death in some impossible site, and the cops never get leads, and Harper was always provably in the next state? But OK on a personal level. Certainly someone you'd rather have inside the tent pissing out than outside pissing in. Which is tricky because Harper is a Sleeper but is *not* OOSG.
- **Roger Crowne:** Some dude you picked up in Canada. OOSG says he's all right, so you're taking it on faith. Seems pretty dull. Again, not a Sleeper. Man, keeping track of this shit is complicated.

YOUR JUNK

- Wolfskin cloak. If you put this on—this, and nothing else, the nakedness is super important—you transform into a wolf, more or less. You don't *physically* change, but you get hella strong and fast and one time you think you actually bit someone's wrist hard enough to break bone. Also, you appear to be a wolf on camera, which proves it's all true. (While transformed, your hand-to-hand attacks are like knife attacks. Also, you appear as a wolf in recordings.)
- Diner's Club card with a high limit
- Leased 2019 BMW
- Handcrafted Italian leather brogues

THE OPPO

Sleepers - A shadowy group that attempts to suppress public awareness of the supernatural. Mystics who get "noisy" (who let the mundanes see magic) risk waking the "sleeping tiger." They'll make the mundanes riot. It's your job to keep magiciansss quiet, the public soothed, and the tiger asleep. Rock-a-bye, baby.

